

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a single voice part in 3/4 time, featuring a treble clef and a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is simple and lyrical, with notes often tied across bar lines. The lyrics are presented in three systems, each with three lines of text. Chord symbols are placed above the staff at various points: E-flat, Fm, B-flat, E-flat, A-flat, B-flat-sus, B-flat, E-flat, A-flat, Fm, G, E-flat/G, Gm, Fm, B-flat, and E-flat. The lyrics are as follows:

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
twen - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.